Temple complex would need to be provided by the SGPC. Regarding permission to carry the kirpan on Air-India and Indian Airlines flights, she said Air-India was bound by rules applicable to all international carriers and hence no exception could be made. However, the kirpan could be carried on domestic Indian Airlines flights, provided its size was reduced.

On the demand for an All India Gurudwara Act to cover all 'historical' gurudwaras throughout India, she said that it could be considered in consultation with the management of the concerned gurudwaras outside Punjab. The Akalis, however, dropped their demand for renaming the Flying Mail, as it was pointed out that it would be impossible to stop passengers from smoking, and the notoriety of the train running mostly late would not be conducive to a name sacred to the Sikhs.

In the end, the Akalis raised the issue of revising the 'unfavourable' formula announced in 1976 for the sharing of Beas and Ravi rivers between Punjab, Haryana and Rajasthan. Indira Gandhi said that she herself was looking into the problem of equitable sharing of river waters and that discussions were already underway between the Centre and concerned state governments.

P.C. Alexander wrote,

> We got the impression that the Akalis were fairly satisfied with the assurances given by the Prime Minister and we sincerely thought that the Akali leadership would not opt for a confrontation with the government. But it soon became clear that the moderate leadership of Akali party was fast losing its grip over the agitation and the militant sections in the community were no longer under the control of the Akali triumvirate. [5]

Alexander's observation is rather interesting. On the one hand, the 1 Akbar Road group was gradually eroding the hold of the moderate Akali Dal leaders over their peaceful agitation by encouraging and overlooking Bhindranwale's extremism and violence. On the other hand, they were telling the Akali moderates to regain their hold over the agitation before their demands were accepted. It was a Catch-22